TINY JAPANESE · WORKBOOK

First Conversations

Ten everyday situations, from greetings to asking for help.

Beginner · 10 lessons · Speaking & listening

How to use this workbook. Follow the lessons on the website (with the short video for each one), and keep this workbook next to you. Read each page, say everything out loud, do the writing practice and tick your answers in "Check yourself". The answer key is at the back.

Website: tiny-japanese.sabagh1.workers.dev

LESSON 1 OF 10 · 20 MIN

Greetings Through the Day

Goal: By the end you can greet someone at any time of day, thank them, apologise, and say goodbye politely.

Warm-up

Japanese greetings change with the time of day. Mika and Alex meet at different moments, so you can hear all of the main ones. Read each line, then cover the romaji and English to test yourself.

Morning

Mika おはよう ございます！
Ohayou gozaimasu!
Good morning!

Alex おはよう ございます！
Ohayou gozaimasu!
Good morning!

Afternoon and evening

Mika こんにちは！
Konnichiwa!
Hello! (daytime)

Alex こんにちは！
Konnichiwa!
Hello!

Mika こんばんは。
Konbanwa.
Good evening.

Saying goodbye

Mika じゃあ、また あした！
Jaa, mata ashita!
Well then, see you tomorrow!

Alex はい、また あした！
Hai, mata ashita!
Yes, see you tomorrow!

Mika	おやすみなさい。 **Oyasuminasai.** Good night.
Alex	おやすみなさい。 **Oyasuminasai.** Good night.

Vocabulary

JAPANESE	ROMAJI	MEANING
おはようございます	**ohayou gozaimasu**	good morning (polite)
おはよう	**ohayou**	good morning (casual, with friends)
こんにちは	**konnichiwa**	hello, good afternoon
こんばんは	**konbanwa**	good evening
おやすみなさい	**oyasuminasai**	good night
また明日 (またあした)	**mata ashita**	see you tomorrow
ありがとうございます	**arigatou gozaimasu**	thank you (polite)
どういたしまして	**dou itashimashite**	you're welcome
すみません	**sumimasen**	excuse me / sorry / thank you
ごめんなさい	**gomennasai**	I'm sorry
はい	**hai**	yes
いいえ	**iie**	no

Grammar and usage

Polite vs casual
おはよう is fine with friends and family. Add ございます (おはよう ございます) when talking to a teacher, a boss, a shopkeeper, or anyone you don't know well. When you're unsure, choose the polite form.

The は in こんにちは and こんばんは
These greetings are written with は, but it is read “wa”, not “ha”. They began as parts of longer sentences, and the old spelling stayed.

すみません does three jobs
It can mean “excuse me” (to get someone's attention), “sorry” (for a small mistake) and even “thank you” (when someone has gone to trouble for you). It is probably the most useful word in this lesson.

ありがとう vs ありがとうございます
ありがとう is casual. ありがとう ございます is polite. To answer thanks, say どういたしまして, or just a small smile and nod.

Culture note

- In Japan a small nod or bow often goes with a greeting. You don't need to bow deeply, but a slight nod while saying おはよう ございます is a friendly, natural habit.

Check yourself

1. How do you say “Good morning” politely?
◯ A. おはよう ございます ◯ B. こんばんは ◯ C. おやすみなさい

2. You are leaving a friend's house late at night. What do you say?
◯ A. おはよう ◯ B. おやすみなさい ◯ C. こんにちは

3. How is は read in こんにちは?
◯ A. ha ◯ B. ba ◯ C. wa

4. Which word can mean “excuse me”, “sorry” and “thank you”?
◯ A. ごめんなさい ◯ B. すみません ◯ C. いいえ

5. How do you say “See you tomorrow”?
◯ A. また きょう ◯ B. おはよう ございます ◯ C. また あした

6. What do you say after someone thanks you?
◯ A. おやすみなさい ◯ B. どういたしまして ◯ C. ごめんなさい

LESSON 2 OF 10 · 25 MIN

Introducing Yourself

Goal: By the end you can introduce yourself in six or seven short sentences, and ask simple yes/no questions.

Dialogue: A first meeting

Mika
はじめまして。ミカです。
Hajimemashite. Mika desu.
Nice to meet you. I'm Mika.

Alex
はじめまして。アレックスです。アメリカから きました。
Hajimemashite. Arekkusu desu. Amerika kara kimashita.
Nice to meet you. I'm Alex. I came from America.

Mika
アメリカじんですか。
Amerikajin desu ka.
Are you American?

Alex
はい、アメリカじんです。
Hai, Amerikajin desu.
Yes, I'm American.

Mika
がくせいですか。
Gakusei desu ka.
Are you a student?

Alex
はい、がくせいです。ミカさんは？
Hai, gakusei desu. Mika-san wa?
Yes, I'm a student. And you, Mika?

Mika
わたしも がくせいです。
Watashi mo gakusei desu.
I'm a student too.

Alex
よろしく おねがいします！
Yoroshiku onegaishimasu!
Pleased to meet you!

Mika
こちらこそ！
Kochira koso!
Likewise!

Vocabulary

JAPANESE	ROMAJI	MEANING

初めまして (はじめまして)	**hajimemashite**	how do you do? (said at a first meeting)
～です	**~ desu**	is / am / are (polite)
～から来ました (～からきました)	**~ kara kimashita**	I came from ~
～人 (～じん)	**~ jin**	person of ~ (nationality)
学生 (がくせい)	**gakusei**	student
～も	**~ mo**	also, too
～さん	**~ san**	Mr/Ms/Mx ~ (polite name ending)
よろしくお願いします (よろしくおねがいします)	**yoroshiku onegaishimasu**	pleased to meet you
こちらこそ	**kochira koso**	likewise, the pleasure is mine
先生 (せんせい)	**sensei**	teacher
会社員 (かいしゃいん)	**kaishain**	office worker

Countries and nationalities

JAPANESE	ROMAJI	MEANING
日本 (にほん)	**nihon**	Japan
アメリカ	**amerika**	America
イギリス	**igirisu**	the UK
カナダ	**kanada**	Canada
オーストラリア	**oosutoraria**	Australia
ブラジル	**burajiru**	Brazil
インド	**indo**	India
中国 (ちゅうごく)	**chuugoku**	China
韓国 (かんこく)	**kankoku**	South Korea

Grammar

X は Y です — “X is Y”
は marks the topic and です closes the sentence politely. You can drop the topic when it's obvious: アレックスです means “I'm Alex”.

か makes a question
Add か to the end of a sentence to ask a yes/no question: がくせいですか。 (“Are you a student?”). No question mark is needed in Japanese, but in these lessons we sometimes add one for clarity.

も means “too”
Replace は with も to say the same applies to you: わたしも がくせいです (“I'm a student too.”).

から means “from”
アメリカから きました means “I came from America”. To ask the same thing, say どこから きましたか (“Where did you come from?”).

〜じん for nationalities
Add じん to a country name for the person: アメリカじん (an American), にほんじん (a Japanese person). It follows the same pattern for most countries.

〜さん is for other people
Add さん after someone's name to be polite. Never use it for yourself.

Try it yourself

- Make your own introduction by filling in this pattern: はじめまして。(name)です。(country)から きました。(country)じんです。よろしく おねがいします。
- Say it aloud three times, then say it without looking.

Check yourself

1. What does か at the end of a sentence do?
◯ A. It makes the sentence negative ◯ B. It makes a question ◯ C. It means “and”

2. How do you say “I'm a student too”?
◯ A. わたしは がくせいですか。 ◯ B. わたしも がくせいです。 ◯ C. わたしも アメリカじんです。

3. What does アメリカから きました mean?
◯ A. I came from America. ◯ B. Are you American? ◯ C. I like America.

4. Which ending should you NEVER put after your own name?
◯ A. 〜も ◯ B. 〜さん ◯ C. 〜です

5. How do you say “Pleased to meet you” after introducing yourself?
◯ A. よろしく おねがいします ◯ B. おやすみなさい ◯ C. ありがとう ございます

6. How do you say “a Japanese person”?
◯ A. にほんじん ◯ B. にほんから ◯ C. にほんです

LESSON 3 OF 10 · 30 MIN

Numbers and Counting

Goal: By the end you can count to 100, ask and say someone's age, and read out a phone number.

Dialogue: Age and phone number

Alex ミカさんは なんさいですか。
Mika-san wa nansai desu ka.
How old are you, Mika?

Mika はたちです。アレックスさんは？
Hatachi desu. Arekkusu-san wa?
I'm twenty. And you, Alex?

Alex わたしも はたちです。
Watashi mo hatachi desu.
I'm twenty too.

Mika おなじですね！
Onaji desu ne!
We're the same age!

Alex でんわばんごうを おしえて ください。
Denwa bangou o oshiete kudasai.
Please tell me your phone number.

Mika はい。ゼロ はち ゼロ の いち に さん よん の ご ろく なな はち です。
Hai. Zero hachi zero no ichi ni san yon no go roku nana hachi desu.
Sure. It's 080-1234-5678.

Alex ありがとう ございます！
Arigatou gozaimasu!
Thank you!

Numbers 0 to 10

JAPANESE	ROMAJI	MEANING
0 (ゼロ / れい)	**zero / rei**	zero
1 (いち)	**ichi**	one
2 (に)	**ni**	two
3 (さん)	**san**	three

4 (よん / し)	**yon / shi**	four
5 (ご)	**go**	five
6 (ろく)	**roku**	six
7 (なな / しち)	**nana / shichi**	seven
8 (はち)	**hachi**	eight
9 (きゅう / く)	**kyuu / ku**	nine
10 (じゅう)	**juu**	ten

Making bigger numbers

11 to 99 are built from 10
じゅういち (11), じゅうに (12), … じゅうきゅう (19). Then にじゅう (20 = 2 × 10), さんじゅう (30), よんじゅう (40), … きゅうじゅう (90). So 25 is にじゅうご (“twenty-five”) and 99 is きゅうじゅうきゅう.

Hundreds and thousands
ひゃく (100), せん (1,000), いちまん (10,000). Watch the exceptions: さんびゃく (300), ろっぴゃく (600), はっぴゃく (800), さんぜん (3,000), はっせん (8,000).

よん and なな are the everyday choices
Both 4 and 7 have two readings. In phone numbers and most counting, よん and なな are clearest. し and しち appear in set phrases such as しがつ (April) and しちじ (seven o'clock).

Age: ～さい

Add さい after the number
ごさい (5), ろくさい (6), ななさい (7), きゅうさい (9). A few change: いっさい (1), はっさい (8), じゅっさい (10).

Twenty is special
20 years old is はたち, not にじゅっさい. After that, it's regular: にじゅういっさい (21), にじゅうにさい (22).

Asking age
なんさいですか (“How old are you?”) is fine with a friend. With an adult you've just met, some people prefer to avoid it, so use it with friends of a similar age.

Phone numbers

Say each digit and use の for the dash
080-1234-5678 is ゼロ はち ゼロ の いち に さん よん の ご ろく なな はち. Say the digits one by one, and link the groups with の. Zero is often said ゼロ in phone numbers (れい is also common).

ね at the end of a sentence
おなじですね means “it's the same, isn't it?”. ね seeks agreement or shows a shared feeling, like “right?” or “isn't it?” in English.

Check yourself

1. What is ごじゅう?

◯ A. 50 ◯ B. 5 ◯ C. 15

2. How do you say 20 years old?

◯ A. はたち ◯ B. にじゅうさい ◯ C. にさい

3. What does なんさいですか mean?

◯ A. How much is it? ◯ B. How old are you? ◯ C. What time is it?

4. How do you read 300?

◯ A. さんひゃく ◯ B. さんびゃく ◯ C. さんせん

5. In a phone number, which word usually links groups of digits (like the dash)?

◯ A. を ◯ B. は ◯ C. の

6. Which number is ろく?

◯ A. 6 ◯ B. 9 ◯ C. 7

7. What does ね add at the end of おなじですね?

◯ A. It makes a question about time ◯ B. It seeks agreement (“right?”) ◯ C. It means “not”

LESSON 4 OF 10 · 30 MIN

Ordering Food and Drinks

Goal: By the end you can order food and drink politely, count items, and finish a meal with the right phrases.

Dialogue: At a restaurant

Clerk いらっしゃいませ！
Irasshaimase!
Welcome!

Alex すみません、メニューを おねがいします。
Sumimasen, menyuu o onegaishimasu.
Excuse me, could we have the menu, please?

Alex ラーメンを ひとつ ください。
Raamen o hitotsu kudasai.
One ramen, please.

Mika わたしは カレーを ください。
Watashi wa karee o kudasai.
I'll have the curry, please.

Clerk おのみものは？
Onomimono wa?
And to drink?

Alex みずを おねがいします。
Mizu o onegaishimasu.
Water, please.

Clerk かしこまりました。
Kashikomarimashita.
Certainly.

Alex いただきます！
Itadakimasu!
Let's eat!

Mika おいしいですね！
Oishii desu ne!
It's delicious!

Alex ええ、とても おいしいです！
Ee, totemo oishii desu!
Yes, it's really delicious!

Alex	すみません、おかんじょう おねがいします。 **Sumimasen, okanjou onegaishimasu.** Excuse me, the bill please.
Alex	ごちそうさまでした！ **Gochisousama deshita!** Thank you for the meal!

Vocabulary

JAPANESE	ROMAJI	MEANING
いらっしゃいませ	**irasshaimase**	welcome (said by staff)
メニュー	**menyuu**	menu
ラーメン	**raamen**	ramen
カレー	**karee**	curry
水 (みず)	**mizu**	water
お茶 (おちゃ)	**ocha**	tea
お飲み物 (おのみもの)	**onomimono**	drinks
～をください	**~ o kudasai**	please give me ~
～をお願いします (～をおねがいします)	**~ o onegaishimasu**	~, please
かしこまりました	**kashikomarimashita**	certainly (said by staff)
おいしい	**oishii**	delicious
とても	**totemo**	very
お勘定 (おかんじょう)	**okanjou**	the bill
いただきます	**itadakimasu**	said before eating
ごちそうさまでした	**gochisousama deshita**	said after eating, thank you for the meal

Counting things (1 to 10)

JAPANESE	ROMAJI	MEANING
1つ (ひとつ)	**hitotsu**	one

2つ (ふたつ)	**futatsu**	two
3つ (みっつ)	**mittsu**	three
4つ (よっつ)	**yottsu**	four
5つ (いつつ)	**itsutsu**	five
6つ (むっつ)	**muttsu**	six
7つ (ななつ)	**nanatsu**	seven
8つ (やっつ)	**yattsu**	eight
9つ (ここのつ)	**kokonotsu**	nine
10 (とお)	**too**	ten

Grammar

X を ください — “Please give me X”
を marks the thing you're asking for. ラーメンを ください is direct and polite. You can add a count after: ラーメンを ふたつ ください (“Two ramen, please.”).

X を おねがいします — “X, please”
This is a softer, slightly more formal way to ask. In a restaurant, either one works; おねがいします is a safe all-purpose choice.

Counting with ひとつ, ふたつ…
This set of numbers counts general objects up to ten. Say the item first (を), then the number, then ください.

いただきます and ごちそうさまでした
Say いただきます before you eat and ごちそうさまでした when you finish. They are small thank-you rituals rather than word-for-word translations, and they are said at nearly every meal.

おいしいですね
とても おいしいです means “It's very delicious.” Adding ね (“isn't it?”) invites your friend to agree and makes the meal feel shared.

Check yourself

1. How do you say “Two ramen, please”?

◯ A. ラーメンを ふたつ ください。 ◯ B. ラーメンは ふたつです。
◯ C. ラーメンを ひとつ ください。

2. What do you say before you start eating?

◯ A. いらっしゃいませ ◯ B. ごちそうさまでした ◯ C. いただきます

3. What does おいしい mean?

◯ A. expensive ◯ B. cheap ◯ C. delicious

4. How do you ask for the bill?

◯ A. おかんじょう おねがいします ◯ B. おみず ください ◯ C. メニューを おねがいします

5. What does いらっしゃいませ mean?

◯ A. Thank you! ◯ B. Goodbye! ◯ C. Welcome!

6. Which word means “three things”?

◯ A. ふたつ ◯ B. むっつ ◯ C. みっつ

7. What does をください do in a sentence?

◯ A. It asks a question ◯ B. It asks for something ◯ C. It says goodbye

LESSON 5 OF 10 · 30 MIN

Shopping and Prices

Goal: By the end you can ask how much something is, understand a price, and say you'll take it.

Dialogue: In a shop

Alex すみません、これは いくらですか。
Sumimasen, kore wa ikura desu ka.
Excuse me, how much is this?

Clerk それは さんぜん ごひゃく えんです。
Sore wa sanzen gohyaku en desu.
That one is 3,500 yen.

Alex ちょっと たかいですね。
Chotto takai desu ne.
It's a little expensive, isn't it?

Alex あれは いくらですか。
Are wa ikura desu ka.
How much is that one over there?

Clerk あれは にせん えんです。
Are wa nisen en desu.
That one is 2,000 yen.

Mika やすいですね！
Yasui desu ne!
It's cheap!

Alex じゃあ、あれを ください。
Jaa, are o kudasai.
Then I'll take that one.

Alex カードは つかえますか。
Kaado wa tsukaemasu ka.
Can I use a card?

Clerk はい、つかえます。ありがとう ございます。
Hai, tsukaemasu. Arigatou gozaimasu.
Yes, you can. Thank you.

Vocabulary

JAPANESE	ROMAJI	MEANING
これ	**kore**	this (near me)

それ	**sore**	that (near you)
あれ	**are**	that over there (far from both)
いくら	**ikura**	how much
円 (えん)	**en**	yen
高い (たかい)	**takai**	expensive, tall
安い (やすい)	**yasui**	cheap
ちょっと	**chotto**	a little
じゃあ	**jaa**	well then
カード	**kaado**	card
使えます (つかえます)	**tsukaemasu**	can be used
現金 (げんきん)	**genkin**	cash

Grammar

これ / それ / あれ
These three words point at things by distance. これ is near the speaker, それ is near the listener, あれ is far from both. In a shop, you say これ for what you're holding, and the clerk answers with それ.

X は いくらですか — "How much is X?"
いくら is "how much". Put the item first with は, then いくらですか. This is the most useful shopping sentence.

Prices in yen
Add えん after the number: せんえん (1,000 yen), にせんえん (2,000), さんぜん ごひゃく えん (3,500). Prices follow the number rules from Lesson 3, including the exceptions for 300, 600, 800, 3,000 and 8,000.

ちょっと as a softener
ちょっと literally means "a little". Japanese speakers use it to soften an opinion so it doesn't sound harsh: ちょっと たかいですね is a polite way of saying "that's a bit pricey."

じゃあ — "well then"
Use じゃあ when you reach a decision based on what you just heard: じゃあ、これを ください.

Check yourself

1. Which word means "this (near me)"?

○ A. これ　○ B. あれ　○ C. それ

2. How do you ask “How much is this?”

◯ A. これは いくらですか。 ◯ B. これは なんじですか。 ◯ C. これは どこですか。

3. What is にせんえん?

◯ A. 20 yen ◯ B. 2,000 yen ◯ C. 200 yen

4. What does ちょっと たかいですね mean?

◯ A. Where is the station? ◯ B. It's very cheap! ◯ C. It's a little expensive, isn't it?

5. How do you say 3,000?

◯ A. さんぜん ◯ B. さんひゃく ◯ C. さんびゃく

6. You want to ask whether you can pay by card. What do you say?

◯ A. いくらですか。 ◯ B. カードは つかえますか。 ◯ C. カードを ください。

7. What does やすい mean?

◯ A. expensive ◯ B. small ◯ C. cheap

LESSON 6 OF 10 · 25 MIN

Asking for Directions

Goal: By the end you can ask where something is and follow a simple answer.

Dialogue: Where is it?

Alex すみません、コンビニは どこですか。
Sumimasen, konbini wa doko desu ka.
Excuse me, where is the convenience store?

Mika コンビニですか。あそこです。
Konbini desu ka. Asoko desu.
The convenience store? It's over there.

Mika まっすぐ いって、みぎです。
Massugu itte, migi desu.
Go straight, and it's on the right.

Alex まっすぐ、みぎ。わかりました。
Massugu, migi. Wakarimashita.
Straight, then right. Got it.

Alex あの、トイレは どこですか。
Ano, toire wa doko desu ka.
Um, where is the restroom?

Mika トイレは えきの ちかくです。ひだりですよ。
Toire wa eki no chikaku desu. Hidari desu yo.
The restroom is near the station. It's on the left.

Alex ありがとう ございます！
Arigatou gozaimasu!
Thank you!

Mika いいえ。
Iie.
Not at all.

Vocabulary

JAPANESE	ROMAJI	MEANING
どこ	**doko**	where
ここ	**koko**	here

そこ	**soko**	there (near you)
あそこ	**asoko**	over there
まっすぐ	**massugu**	straight ahead
右 (みぎ)	**migi**	right
左 (ひだり)	**hidari**	left
近く (ちかく)	**chikaku**	nearby
駅 (えき)	**eki**	station
トイレ	**toire**	restroom, toilet
コンビニ	**konbini**	convenience store
あの	**ano**	um, excuse me
分かりました (わかりました)	**wakarimashita**	I understand, got it

Grammar

X は どこですか — “Where is X?”
Put the place first with は and end with どこですか. The answer repeats the pattern: X は ここです (“It's here”), あそこです (“It's over there”).

ここ / そこ / あそこ
Like これ/それ/あれ, but for places. ここ is where I am, そこ is where you are, あそこ is far from both of us.

X の ちかく — “near X”
の links two nouns, as in lesson 5 of our hiragana course: えきの ちかく means “near the station”.

まっすぐ いって — “go straight”
いって is a form of “go” meaning “go and then …”. You don't need to learn the grammar yet: just remember the phrase まっすぐ いって, みぎ / ひだり です.

よ at the end
よ adds “I'm telling you” or “by the way”. ひだりですよ means “it's on the left, you know.”. Use it to share information the other person may not know.

Useful tip

- あの is a gentle way to get someone's attention before a question: あの、すみません。 Either word on its own, or both together, makes a good opening when you ask a stranger for help.

Check yourself

1. How do you ask “Where is the station?”

◯ A. えきは いくらですか。 ◯ B. えきは なんじですか。 ◯ C. えきは どこですか。

2. What does まっすぐ mean?

◯ A. left ◯ B. straight ahead ◯ C. nearby

3. Which word means “left”?

◯ A. ひだり ◯ B. ちかく ◯ C. みぎ

4. Which word means “over there”?

◯ A. そこ ◯ B. あそこ ◯ C. ここ

5. What does えきの ちかく mean?

◯ A. in the station ◯ B. near the station ◯ C. far from the station

6. What does ひだりですよ add to ひだりです?

◯ A. It makes it negative ◯ B. It adds “I'm telling you” ◯ C. It makes it a question

7. What does わかりました mean?

◯ A. I understand ◯ B. Thank you ◯ C. I'm sorry

LESSON 7 OF 10 · 30 MIN

Telling the Time and Days

Goal: By the end you can ask and tell the time, say today and tomorrow, and name the days of the week.

Dialogue: Time and days

Alex いま なんじですか。
Ima nanji desu ka.
What time is it now?

Mika いま さんじ はんです。
Ima sanji han desu.
It's half past three.

Alex えいがは なんじからですか。
Eiga wa nanji kara desu ka.
What time does the movie start?

Mika ごじ じゅっぷんからです。
Goji juppun kara desu.
It starts at 5:10.

Alex きょうは なんようびですか。
Kyou wa nan'youbi desu ka.
What day of the week is it today?

Mika きょうは すいようびです。
Kyou wa suiyoubi desu.
Today is Wednesday.

Alex あしたは？
Ashita wa?
And tomorrow?

Mika あしたは もくようびです。
Ashita wa mokuyoubi desu.
Tomorrow is Thursday.

The hours (〜じ)

JAPANESE	ROMAJI	MEANING
1時 (いちじ)	**ichiji**	1 o'clock
2時 (にじ)	**niji**	2 o'clock

3時 (さんじ)	**sanji**	3 o'clock
4時 (よじ)	**yoji**	4 o'clock (not よんじ)
5時 (ごじ)	**goji**	5 o'clock
6時 (ろくじ)	**rokuji**	6 o'clock
7時 (しちじ)	**shichiji**	7 o'clock (not ななじ)
8時 (はちじ)	**hachiji**	8 o'clock
9時 (くじ)	**kuji**	9 o'clock (not きゅうじ)
10時 (じゅうじ)	**juuji**	10 o'clock
11時 (じゅういちじ)	**juuichiji**	11 o'clock
12時 (じゅうにじ)	**juuniji**	12 o'clock

Minutes, times of day and days

JAPANESE	ROMAJI	MEANING
半 (はん)	**han**	half (past the hour)
〜分 (〜ふん / 〜ぷん)	**~ fun / ~ pun**	minutes
午前 (ごぜん)	**gozen**	a.m.
午後 (ごご)	**gogo**	p.m.
今 (いま)	**ima**	now
今日 (きょう)	**kyou**	today
明日 (あした)	**ashita**	tomorrow
昨日 (きのう)	**kinou**	yesterday
何時 (なんじ)	**nanji**	what time?
何曜日 (なんようび)	**nan'youbi**	what day of the week?
日曜日 (にちようび)	**nichiyoubi**	Sunday
月曜日 (げつようび)	**getsuyoubi**	Monday
火曜日 (かようび)	**kayoubi**	Tuesday

水曜日 (すいようび)	**suiyoubi**	Wednesday
木曜日 (もくようび)	**mokuyoubi**	Thursday
金曜日 (きんようび)	**kinyoubi**	Friday
土曜日 (どようび)	**doyoubi**	Saturday

Grammar

Hours: number + じ
Most hours are regular: ごじ (5), ろくじ (6). Three are special: よじ (4), しちじ (7), くじ (9).

Minutes: ふん or ぷん
Minutes change with the number. 2, 5, 7, 9 use ふん (にふん, ごふん, ななふん, きゅうふん). 1, 3, 4, 6, 8, 10 use ぷん (いっぷん, さんぷん, よんぷん, ろっぷん, はっぷん, じゅっぷん). Don't worry about memorising all of it at once: start with はん (“half past”) and じゅっぷん (“10 minutes”).

Half past: はん
さんじ はん means 3:30. Japanese often says はん instead of さんじゅっぷん.

a.m. and p.m. come first
ごぜん くじ is 9 a.m. and ごご さんじ is 3 p.m. Put the a.m./p.m. word in front of the time.

から means “starting from”
ごじからです means “It starts at 5.” In lesson 2 から meant “from a place”; here it means “from a time”.

Days of the week
Each day is named after a natural element: にち (sun), げつ (moon), か (fire), すい (water), もく (wood), きん (gold), ど (earth), plus ようび (“day of the week”).

Check yourself

1. How do you say 4 o'clock?
◯ A. しじ ◯ B. よんじ ◯ C. よじ

2. How do you say 9 o'clock?
◯ A. くじ ◯ B. ここのじ ◯ C. きゅうじ

3. What does さんじ はん mean?
◯ A. 3:10 ◯ B. 3:30 ◯ C. 13:00

4. Which day is すいようび?
◯ A. Wednesday ◯ B. Thursday ◯ C. Tuesday

5. What does ごご mean?
◯ A. a.m. ◯ B. p.m. ◯ C. tomorrow

6. Which is the correct way to ask “What time is it?”

◯ A. いま なんじですか。　◯ B. いま いくらですか。　◯ C. いま なんようびですか。

7. What does きのう mean?

◯ A. tomorrow　◯ B. yesterday　◯ C. today

LESSON 8 OF 10 · 25 MIN

Likes and Dislikes

Goal: By the end you can say what you like, ask others, and politely say you don't like something.

Dialogue: Favourite things

Mika アレックスさんは なにが すきですか。
Arekkusu-san wa nani ga suki desu ka.
What do you like, Alex?

Alex わたしは ラーメンが すきです。
Watashi wa raamen ga suki desu.
I like ramen.

Mika ほんとうですか！わたしも だいすきです。
Hontou desu ka! Watashi mo daisuki desu.
Really? I love it too.

Mika アニメは すきですか。
Anime wa suki desu ka.
Do you like anime?

Alex はい、だいすきです！
Hai, daisuki desu!
Yes, I love it!

Mika さかなは？
Sakana wa?
What about fish?

Alex さかなは あまり すきじゃ ないです。
Sakana wa amari suki ja nai desu.
I don't really like fish.

Mika そうですか。じゃあ、おにくは？
Sou desu ka. Jaa, oniku wa?
I see. Then what about meat?

Alex おにくは だいすきです！
Oniku wa daisuki desu!
I love meat!

Vocabulary

JAPANESE	ROMAJI	MEANING
好き (すき)	**suki**	like, fond of

大好き (だいすき)	**daisuki**	love, really like
あまり～ない	**amari ~ nai**	not very ~
何 (なに)	**nani**	what
本当ですか (ほんとうですか)	**hontou desu ka**	really?
そうですか	**sou desu ka**	I see, is that so
魚 (さかな)	**sakana**	fish
お肉 (おにく)	**oniku**	meat
ラーメン	**raamen**	ramen
アニメ	**anime**	anime
音楽 (おんがく)	**ongaku**	music
猫 (ねこ)	**neko**	cat
犬 (いぬ)	**inu**	dog

Grammar

X が すきです — “I like X”
Use が (not を) for things you like. ラーメンが すきです means “I like ramen.” To ask: ラーメンが すきですか。 Note that the liked thing takes が in Japanese.

だいすき — “love”
だいすきです is stronger than すきです. It's used for people, food and hobbies. It's warm and natural, not a big romantic statement.

Saying you don't like it
すきじゃ ないです means “I don't like it.” Add あまり (“not very”) to soften it: あまり すきじゃ ないです. A more formal version is あまり すきじゃ ありません.

Avoid きらい
きらい means “dislike”, but it sounds strong in Japanese. It's usually better to say あまり すきじゃ ないです.

そうですか and ほんとうですか
そうですか means “I see” and ほんとうですか means “really?”. They are very common reactions that keep a conversation going.

Check yourself

1. Which particle marks the thing you like?

○ A. が ○ B. を ○ C. へ

2. How do you say “I love anime”?

◯ A. アニメが だいすきです。 ◯ B. アニメを ください。 ◯ C. アニメは どこですか。

3. What is a polite, soft way to say you don't like something?

◯ A. きらいです ◯ B. あまり すきじゃ ないです ◯ C. だいすきです

4. What does ほんとうですか mean?

◯ A. How much is it? ◯ B. Really? ◯ C. Where is it?

5. Which word means “what”?

◯ A. なに ◯ B. どこ ◯ C. いくら

6. What does そうですか mean?

◯ A. Good night ◯ B. No thank you ◯ C. I see

LESSON 9 OF 10 · 30 MIN

Making Plans Together

Goal: By the end you can invite a friend, say yes, and arrange a time and place to meet.

Dialogue: Let's go to a movie

Mika アレックスさん、あした ひまですか。
Arekkusu-san, ashita hima desu ka.
Alex, are you free tomorrow?

Alex はい、ひまです。
Hai, hima desu.
Yes, I'm free.

Mika じゃあ、いっしょに えいがを みませんか。
Jaa, issho ni eiga o mimasen ka.
Then, would you like to watch a movie together?

Alex いいですね！なんじに あいますか。
Ii desu ne! Nanji ni aimasu ka.
Sounds good! What time shall we meet?

Mika ごご ろくじに えきで あいましょう。
Gogo rokuji ni eki de aimashou.
Let's meet at the station at 6 p.m.

Alex わかりました。たのしみです！
Wakarimashita. Tanoshimi desu!
Got it. I'm looking forward to it!

Mika じゃあ、また あした！
Jaa, mata ashita!
See you tomorrow, then!

Vocabulary

JAPANESE	ROMAJI	MEANING
暇 (ひま)	**hima**	free (not busy)
一緒に (いっしょに)	**issho ni**	together
映画 (えいが)	**eiga**	movie
見ます (みます)	**mimasu**	see, watch

会います (あいます)	**aimasu**	meet
行きます (いきます)	**ikimasu**	go
食べます (たべます)	**tabemasu**	eat
飲みます (のみます)	**nomimasu**	drink
買います (かいます)	**kaimasu**	buy
いいですね	**ii desu ne**	sounds good
楽しみです (たのしみです)	**tanoshimi desu**	I'm looking forward to it

Grammar

The polite verb ending ます
Polite verbs end in 〜ます: いきます (go), たべます (eat), のみます (drink), みます (watch), あいます (meet). This is the form you'll hear most often when talking to someone you don't know well.

〜ませんか — "Would you like to …?"
Change ます to ませんか to invite someone: えいがを みませんか。 ("Would you like to watch a movie?"). It sounds gentle and gives the other person room to say no.

〜ましょう — "Let's …"
Change ます to ましょう to suggest or agree to something: あいましょう ("Let's meet"). It is the natural answer when a plan is already being made.

に marks a time, で marks where it happens
ろくじに ("at six") uses に for the time. えきで ("at the station") uses で for the place where an action happens.

いっしょに — "together"
A small word that makes any invitation friendlier: いっしょに ごはんを たべませんか。

How to say no politely

- Japanese speakers often avoid a direct "no". Instead of いいえ you might hear ちょっと… ("That's a bit…"), which means "I'd rather not" or "I can't". Now you know what it means if someone says it to your invitation.

Check yourself

1. How do you invite someone politely?
◯ A. 〜ませんか ◯ B. 〜です ◯ C. 〜でした

2. What does あいましょう mean?
◯ A. I don't meet ◯ B. Did you meet? ◯ C. Let's meet

3. Which particle marks a time (like “at six”)?

◯ A. に ◯ B. を ◯ C. で

4. Which particle marks the place where something happens?

◯ A. に ◯ B. で ◯ C. は

5. What does いっしょに mean?

◯ A. tomorrow ◯ B. quickly ◯ C. together

6. What does たのしみです mean?

◯ A. I'm sorry ◯ B. I'm looking forward to it ◯ C. I'm busy

7. If someone answers an invitation with ちょっと…, they probably mean:

◯ A. Probably no ◯ B. I didn't hear you ◯ C. Yes, definitely

LESSON 10 OF 10 · 25 MIN

Asking for Help

Goal: By the end you can say you don't understand, ask for repetition, ask what something is called, and call for help.

Dialogue: I don't understand

Alex すみません、にほんごが あまり わかりません。
Sumimasen, nihongo ga amari wakarimasen.
Sorry, I don't understand Japanese very well.

Clerk だいじょうぶですよ。
Daijoubu desu yo.
That's okay.

Alex もう いちど おねがいします。
Mou ichido onegaishimasu.
One more time, please.

Alex もう すこし ゆっくり おねがいします。
Mou sukoshi yukkuri onegaishimasu.
A little slower, please.

Alex えいごが わかりますか。
Eigo ga wakarimasu ka.
Do you understand English?

Clerk すこしだけ わかります。
Sukoshi dake wakarimasu.
Only a little.

Alex これは にほんごで なんと いいますか。
Kore wa nihongo de nan to iimasu ka.
What do you call this in Japanese?

Clerk それは「かさ」です。
Sore wa “kasa” desu.
That's “kasa”.

Alex かさ。ありがとう ございます！
Kasa. Arigatou gozaimasu!
Kasa. Thank you!

Vocabulary

JAPANESE	ROMAJI	MEANING

分かります (わかります)	**wakarimasu**	understand
分かりません (わかりません)	**wakarimasen**	don't understand
もう一度 (もういちど)	**mou ichido**	one more time
ゆっくり	**yukkuri**	slowly
少し (すこし)	**sukoshi**	a little
大丈夫 (だいじょうぶ)	**daijoubu**	okay, fine
英語 (えいご)	**eigo**	English
日本語 (にほんご)	**nihongo**	Japanese language
〜で何と言いますか (〜でなんといいますか)	**~ de nan to iimasu ka**	what do you call ~ in ~?
教えてください (おしえてください)	**oshiete kudasai**	please tell me, please teach me

Emergencies

JAPANESE	ROMAJI	MEANING
助けて！ (たすけて)	**tasukete**	help!
病院 (びょういん)	**byouin**	hospital
警察 (けいさつ)	**keisatsu**	police
救急車 (きゅうきゅうしゃ)	**kyuukyuusha**	ambulance
気分が悪いです (きぶんがわるいです)	**kibun ga warui desu**	I feel unwell

Grammar

わかります and わかりません
わかります means “I understand” and わかりません means “I don't understand”. Remember the ません ending: it's the negative form of ます, so you'll see it in many more verbs.

X が わかります
Like すき, わかります uses が: にほんごが わかりません means “I don't understand Japanese.”

おねがいします makes a request
もう いちど おねがいします (“once more, please”) and ゆっくり おねがいします (“slowly, please”) are two phrases that can save any conversation.

〜で なんと いいますか
Point at something and ask これは にほんごで なんと いいますか。 (“What is this called in Japanese?”). You can swap にほんごで for えいごで.

Emergency numbers
In Japan the police number is 110, and the fire and ambulance number is 119. Say たすけて！ (“Help!”) to get people's attention, and びょういん (“hospital”) if you need medical care.

Where to go next

- You've finished the course. Revisit the dialogues and cover the romaji and English to test yourself.
- Try creating your own short dialogue using at least one phrase from each lesson, then say it aloud.
- Keep an eye on new Tiny Japanese lessons and courses on this site.

Check yourself

1. How do you say “I don't understand”?
◯ A. わかります ◯ B. だいじょうぶです ◯ C. わかりません

2. Which phrase means “One more time, please”?
◯ A. だいじょうぶですよ ◯ B. もう すこし ゆっくり ◯ C. もう いちど おねがいします

3. How do you ask “What is this called in Japanese?”
◯ A. これは いくらですか。 ◯ B. これは どこですか。
◯ C. これは にほんごで なんと いいますか。

4. What does ゆっくり mean?
◯ A. quickly ◯ B. together ◯ C. slowly

5. What is the emergency number for the police in Japan?
◯ A. 110 ◯ B. 911 ◯ C. 119

6. Which word do you shout to get help?
◯ A. いただきます！ ◯ B. だいじょうぶ！ ◯ C. たすけて！

Answer key

Lesson 1: Greetings Through the Day

1. A. おはよう ございます
2. B. おやすみなさい
3. C. wa
4. B. すみません
5. C. また あした
6. B. どういたしまして

Lesson 2: Introducing Yourself

1. B. It makes a question
2. B. わたしも がくせいです。
3. A. I came from America.
4. B. ～さん
5. A. よろしく おねがいします
6. A. にほんじん

Lesson 3: Numbers and Counting

1. A. 50
2. A. はたち
3. B. How old are you?
4. B. さんびゃく
5. C. の
6. A. 6
7. B. It seeks agreement (“right?”)

Lesson 4: Ordering Food and Drinks

1. A. ラーメンを ふたつ ください。
2. C. いただきます
3. C. delicious
4. A. おかんじょう おねがいします
5. C. Welcome!
6. C. みっつ
7. B. It asks for something

Lesson 5: Shopping and Prices

1. A. これ
2. A. これは いくらですか。
3. B. 2,000 yen
4. C. It's a little expensive, isn't it?
5. A. さんぜん
6. B. カードは つかえますか。
7. C. cheap

Lesson 6: Asking for Directions

1. C. えきは どこですか。
2. B. straight ahead
3. A. ひだり
4. B. あそこ
5. B. near the station
6. B. It adds “I'm telling you”
7. A. I understand

Lesson 7: Telling the Time and Days

1. C. よじ
2. A. くじ
3. B. 3:30
4. A. Wednesday
5. B. p.m.
6. A. いま なんじですか。
7. B. yesterday

Lesson 8: Likes and Dislikes

1. A. が
2. A. アニメが だいすきです。
3. B. あまり すきじゃ ないです
4. B. Really?
5. A. なに
6. C. I see

Lesson 9: Making Plans Together

1. A. ～ませんか
2. C. Let's meet
3. A. に
4. B. で
5. C. together
6. B. I'm looking forward to it
7. A. Probably no

Lesson 10: Asking for Help

1. C. わかりません
2. C. もう いちど おねがいします
3. C. これは にほんごで なんと いいますか。
4. C. slowly
5. A. 110
6. C. たすけて！

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